Selling as a Vertical FDE

Front Matter, Chapter 10/12 — Revision & Viva-Prep Cheatsheet (English + Roman Urdu)
Source: agentfactory.panaversity.org/docs/how-to-sell

EN: 3 August 2026: Palantir reported 93% revenue growth from a sales team that is 'minuscule and shrinking'. Lesson: in the agentic era, deployment IS the sales motion -- showing working proof on the buyer's own data replaces the pitch. 'The pitch breaks. The proof doesn't.'
Roman Urdu: 3 August 2026: Palantir ne 93% revenue growth report ki ek sales team se jo 'minuscule and shrinking' hai. Lesson: agentic era mein deployment hi sales motion hai -- buyer ki apni data par working proof dikhana pitch ki jagah leta hai. 'Pitch toot jaati hai. Proof nahi.'

1. What Happened + Palantir's 3 Mechanisms

- Q2 2026: $1.9B revenue (+93% YoY), ~$1.1B profit, from a sales team of ~70 people, only ~7 of whom actually 'sell'.
- **Bootcamp** replaces the pitch -- days spent building something real on the customer's own data; ends in a working capability, not a slide deck.
- **Embedded engineer** replaces the account executive -- an FDE spends ~30-40% of their week on conversational customer discovery (the account-manager job, fused with delivery).
- **Land and expand** replaces the enterprise deal cycle -- small first contract, value proven, then it grows use-case by use-case.

2. The Law: Deployment Is the Sales Motion

- Same shape as the monetization roadmap: build first/sell second = bootcamp logic for one person. Contract of success (3 verifiable numbers) = land-and-expand, stated for one engagement.
- 'Proof replaced the pitch, and the person who makes proof replaced the person who gave the pitch.' Selling didn't vanish -- it moved into a different, less-concentrated job.

3. One-Person Bootcamp + Buyer's Agent Is Already Shortlisting

- Your version of the bootcamp model, solo: a compressed demonstration on the buyer's own data instead of a pitch deck.
- Buyers' own AI agents are already shortlisting vendors before a human ever sees a pitch -- being agent-discoverable now matters as much as being human-persuasive.

4. Earning the First Afternoon + 8 Failure Modes

- What can't be copied: a working result on THIS buyer's own data, measured against THEIR own baseline.
- **8 failure modes** include: leaving without a number, unbounded free work (among others named in file 04).

Key Terms Cheatsheet

One line each — English + Roman Urdu.

Term	English	Roman Urdu
Bootcamp (sales mechanism)	A compressed deployment on the buyer's own data, ending in a working capability.	Buyer ki apni data par compressed deployment, working capability ke sath khatam.
Embedded engineer (sales mechanism)	An FDE who fuses discovery and delivery into one role.	FDE jo discovery aur delivery ek role mein fuse karta hai.
Land and expand	Start with a small contract; grow it use-case by use-case once value is proven.	Chhota contract se shuru karo; value prove hone par use-case by use-case barhao.
Proof cycle	The days between first contact and a measurable working result.	First contact aur measurable working result ke beech ke din.
Deployment is the sales motion	Working proof on the buyer's own data replaces the traditional pitch.	Buyer ki apni data par working proof traditional pitch ki jagah leta hai.

Viva Prep -- Representative Q&A;

Question	Answer
What did Palantir's Q2 2026 earnings reveal about its sales team?	93% YoY revenue growth from a sales team of only ~70 people, ~7 of whom actually sell -- deliberately 'minuscule and shrinking'.
What are Palantir's 3 selling mechanisms?	Bootcamp (replaces the pitch), embedded engineer (replaces the account executive), land and expand (replaces the enterprise deal cycle).
What's the one-sentence law of this chapter?	'Proof replaced the pitch, and the person who makes proof replaced the person who gave the pitch' -- deployment IS the sales motion.
Did selling disappear from Palantir's business?	No -- Palantir still added ~500 net hires in 2025; selling work became less concentrated in a dedicated sales role, not gone.
Why does 'buyer's agent is already shortlisting' matter for a solo FDE?	Being agent-discoverable now matters as much as being human-persuasive -- an AI may filter vendors before a human sees a pitch.

Where This Leads / Sources

Leads to: How to Get Paid (the roadmap this completes). Full appendix + quiz in 06-appendix-sources-and-test-your-understanding.md.

Source: docs/how-to-sell/ (this repo), content originally via Zia Tutor AI connector.